There was no auction or allotment for 5G spectrum during the first nine months of financial year 2021–22. The indications from the government were that these auctions would most likely take place in the middle of year 2022–23.

Power Sector

The electricity business in India was completely confined to the private sector before Independence. Its only issue of concern was safety, as it was a difficult commodity to handle. Initial electricity laws, including the Indian Electricity Act, 1910, therefore dealt only with safety and licencing aspects, with local authorities entrusted with licencing. At the end of calendar year 1947, India had generation capacity of a little under 1400 MW, almost all in the private sector. A number of electricity distribution companies had been licensed, beginning with CESC in Calcutta.

The electricity sector shifted almost completely to the public sector in the 1950s. Electricity generation, transmission and distribution companies were all nationalized and bundled into regional and later state electricity boards. Only a handful of distribution companies remained private. Until 1990, the private sector was completely banished from the power sector. Independent private producers (IPPs) were first permitted to invest in generation in 1991. Under the 1990s version of the power-sector reforms, state electricity boards were reorganized into separate generation, transmission and distribution companies, which led to the privatization of a few distribution companies in Odisha, Delhi and a few other places. Private-sector generation companies invested massively, first in conventional thermal power generation and hydro-generation and, later, in renewable power generation. The private sector was permitted in transmission as well later.

As things stand today, the bulk (over 90 per cent) of power distribution is in the public sector, almost entirely state government-controlled